Detailed Review of Prohibited and Non-Permissible Food Items in the Swaminarayan Sampradaya

Swaminarayan Guidance and References :

The information in this document has been compiled based on the **Shikshapatri, traditional Swaminarayan literature, guidance from BAPS, Vadtal, Ahmedabad Gadi, Swaminarayan saints, other reputable Swaminarayan organizations, reliable religious and scientific sources, and publicly available information**. Where differences in interpretation or practice exist among various Swaminarayan organizations or traditions, they have been appropriately indicated.

Ingredient	Religious Reason & Reference	Scientific / Food Industry Origin
Meat, Chicken, Fish, Seafood, Prawn/Shrimp, Crab, Oyster, Pork, Beef, Mutton/Lamb, Turkey, Egg	Bhagwan Swaminarayan, in **Shikshapatri Verse 15**, has instructed the complete renunciation of meat, eggs, and all animal-derived foods. This is based on the principles of **Ahimsa (non-violence)** and a **pure Satvik diet**. *(Shikshapatri – Verse 15)*	Animal-derived food products obtained from animals, birds, or aquatic creatures.
Onion, Garlic, Leek, Shallot, Chives	In the Swaminarayan tradition, these members of the **Allium** family are considered **Rajasic** and **Tamasic**. They are believed to increase lust, anger, restlessness, and unpleasant body odor; therefore, they are avoided. *(Swaminarayan tradition and BAPS/Vadtal guidance)*	Plants belonging to the **Allium** family, naturally rich in sulfur compounds.
Alcohol, Wine, Beer, Rum, Whisky, Brandy, Vodka, Gin, Spirit, Food Ethanol	According to **Shikshapatri Verses 15 and 18**, all forms of alcoholic beverages and intoxicating substances must be completely avoided. *(Shikshapatri – Verses 15 & 18)*	Alcoholic products produced through **fermentation** or **distillation**.
Cannabis (Bhang), Marijuana (Ganja), Opium, Hashish, and other intoxicating substances	Since these substances impair the mind and senses, the Swaminarayan tradition strictly prohibits their use. *(Shikshapatri – Verse 18)*	Psychoactive / Narcotic substances.
E120 (Carmine / Cochineal), E441 (Gelatin), E542 (Bone Phosphate), E901 (Beeswax), E904 (Shellac), E1105 (Lysozyme)	These food additives are obtained from insects, bees, eggs, or other animal-derived sources and are therefore not acceptable according to Swaminarayan dietary principles. *(Principle of avoiding animal-derived foods in the Shikshapatri and traditional Swaminarayan guidance)*	Respectively derived from cochineal insects (natural color), animal collagen (gelling agent), animal bones (bone phosphate), beeswax, lac insects (natural resin), and egg white (enzyme).
E322 (Lecithin), E422 (Glycerol/Glycerin), E471 (Mono & Diglycerides), E472 Series (Esters of Mono & Diglycerides), E570 (Fatty Acids), E627 (Disodium Guanylate),	These food additives may be derived from **plant, microbial, or animal sources**. If the source is not clearly specified, the Swaminarayan tradition advises verifying the	Industrial food additives that may be produced from vegetable oils, animal fats, eggs, feathers, hair, or microbial fermentation.

Ingredient	Religious Reason & Reference	Scientific / Food Industry Origin
E631 (Disodium Inosinate), E635 (Disodium Ribonucleotides), E920 (L-Cysteine)	source or avoiding the ingredient according to religious guidance.	
Asafoetida (Hing)	In some Swaminarayan traditions, the use of asafoetida is discouraged because it is considered **Rajasic/Tamasic**, and commercially available asafoetida may contain wheat flour, edible gum, or other added ingredients. Practices vary among different Swaminarayan organizations. *(Traditional Swaminarayan guidance)*	A spice obtained from the oleogum resin of **Ferula** species. Commercial asafoetida often contains wheat flour, rice flour, or edible gums as blending agents.

📌 Recommendation

> **Note:** The above information has been prepared based on the **Shikshapatri**, the core religious principles of the Swaminarayan tradition, and the available guidance from various Swaminarayan organizations. For certain items (such as **Asafoetida (Hing)** and some **Food Additives**), practices may vary among different organizations and saints. Therefore, for final religious guidance, please consult your **Guru** or **Swamishri**.

▼ resources —-

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